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Rose

Rose watched from the window: Léa in the car, Katya on her lap. It was Reinhardt's plan. He said the driver would wait a few minutes, then leave. *Easier to have them all in the car. They can't refuse to go without you.* The Panzer tanks rumbled past. The driver revved the engine, and Léa leaned forward, trying to stop him from driving off. When she realized she couldn't, she turned back, her eyes stricken with panic. Rose had done everything Reinhardt asked of her, except for the note she'd slipped into André's hand on which she'd written: *I love you. I always will.*

She shrank from the window of the barracks. How could she have been so cruel? Léa had spent her entire life sacrificing to ensure she was fed and housed, only to have Rose betray her. Maybe she would think it was an accident, that Rose had truly forgotten her drawings. But Léa was too clever not to see it for what it was: a cold, calculated plan designed to separate the sisters. Rose had made a pact with the devil, and now she had to live with it. Taking the ring from her pocket, she slipped it on her finger.

The next four days dragged on as Reinhardt prepared for their new life. He told her they would have different names and live on a farm outside of town, up on the hill. *There will be no trace that I was in the Gestapo.* She couldn't figure that out since everyone in Glashütte and Dippoldiswalde knew him. He worked relentlessly, and she had the sense that far from being despondent about surrendering to the advancing Soviet troops, he wasn't giving up but preparing a new attack in a battle he waged in his mind against the enemy.

"Do as you like now because after the Soviet army arrives—"

"What will happen?"